

Question no:3

King Lear as a tragic drama

Answer:

King Lear as a Tragic Drama:

King Lear by William Shakespeare is one of the greatest tragedies in English literature. It tells the story of a great king whose pride and wrong decisions bring his downfall. The play has all the qualities of a true tragedy — a great hero, a tragic flaw, intense emotions, suffering, and a sad ending.

1.Tragic Hero

The main character, King Lear, is a noble and powerful ruler. But he makes a serious mistake when he divides his kingdom among his daughters. He believes false praise from Goneril and Regan and rejects his honest daughter, Cordelia. His pride and foolishness become his tragic flaw.

Quote 1:

“I did her wrong.” — (King Lear)

Lear realizes his mistake too late, which is a key point in a tragedy.

2.Suffering and Emotions:

As the play goes on, Lear faces great pain. His two elder daughters betray him, and he loses everything — power, respect, and even his sanity. The audience feels pity and fear for him, which are the true emotions of tragedy.

Quote 2:

“O, let me not be mad, not mad, sweet heaven!” — (King Lear)

This shows Lear’s deep fear and suffering as he loses control of his mind.

3.Moral Lesson

Through Lear’s fall, Shakespeare teaches an important lesson — pride and blindness can destroy happiness. The play shows that true love is simple and honest, like Cordelia’s love, not full of false words like her sisters’.

Quote 3:

“How sharper than a serpent’s tooth it is to have a thankless child!” — (King Lear)

This line shows Lear’s pain when he realizes his daughters’ betrayal

4.The Tragic Ending

In the end, Lear and Cordelia both die. It is a sad but meaningful ending. Lear becomes wise before his death — he learns what true love and kindness mean. His suffering brings knowledge and emotional truth.

Conclusion

King Lear is a perfect tragic drama. It shows a noble man destroyed by his own weakness and by fate. Shakespeare makes the audience feel pity, fear, and sadness, while also teaching deep lessons about love, pride, and human nature. That is why King Lear is one of the greatest tragedies ever written.